

Jim Gillespie

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SUMMARY

Versatile technical communicator with a demonstrated history of enabling product success through clear, scalable documentation. Proven ability to reduce support costs, accelerate product adoption, and align cross-functional teams in Agile and Docs-as-Code environments. Skilled at managing multiple projects and deadlines in dynamic settings. Combines proven writing and editing skills with a hands-on understanding of tools, hardware, and systems.

KEY SKILLS

- **Documentation Practices:** Agile development collaboration, CI/CD pipeline documentation, Docs-as-Code workflows, structured authoring and content reuse, source control, data visualization, API and SaaS product documentation, hardware/software/systems documentation
- **Deliverables:** API references, installation guides, procedures, quick start guides, readme files, release notes, specifications, user manuals, white papers, workflows
- **Languages & Standards:** HTML/CSS, XML, DITA, Markdown, OpenAPI/Swagger, JavaScript, Python, Java, C++
- **Tools:** Acrobat Pro, Adobe Experience Manager, Alfresco CMS, Azure DevOps, Confluence, FrameMaker, Git, GitHub, Illustrator, InDesign, Jira, Lucidchart, Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Visio), Oxygen Author, Perforce, Photoshop, SDL/Trisoft CMS, SharePoint, Trello, Visual Studio, VS Code, WordPress, XMetaL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Writer | Independent Consultant | Austin, TX | Jan 2024–Present

- Conducted peer code reviews, providing feedback on developer-facing documentation.
- Applied writing and editing expertise to improve resumes for a diverse range of job seekers.
- Completed targeted coursework in cloud architecture, API design, and generative AI to deepen domain knowledge and expand documentation capabilities.

Senior Technical Writer | National Instruments | Austin, TX | Feb 2014–Dec 2023

- Crafted documentation that led to fewer customer support calls and savings in product support costs.
- Documented beta releases that propelled customer sales and facilitated marketing of automotive test solutions.
- Updated hardware specs and revamped the PXIe-4322 user manual, securing stakeholder approval and enabling \$1.5M in customer order fulfillment.
- Migrated product documentation and build components from Perforce to Git, integrating with a developer-focused toolchain including Jira, Confluence, and Microsoft Azure DevOps.
- Established a cross-team documentation review process optimized for software development, hardware calibration, and compliance reviewers across global locations.
- Led monthly cross-functional meetings with Metrology, Calibration, and Technical Communication departments to prioritize projects, resolve issues, and ensure alignment.

Information Developer | HP TippingPoint (Contract) | Austin, TX | Jan 2013–Feb 2014

- Documented HP Tipping Point's first Next Generation Firewall system.
- Collaborated with HP's UX team to ensure efficient process flow and product usability.
- Championed UX and documentation concerns in product development team scrums.
- Mentored new writers, training them on processes, tools, and best practices.
- Led writers through training and certifications in HPE network security solutions.

Technical Writer | AMD (Contract) | Austin, TX | Nov 2011–Dec 2012

- Analyzed processor design and reference guides, organized content into book-level DITA maps, and coded XML for FrameMaker-to-DITA document conversions.
- Streamlined DITA conversion, authoring, and documentation production processes using a new toolchain and customized scripts.
- Trained a team of 10 writers on using Oxygen Author, DITA conditional processing, SVN, and Alfresco CMS to create, edit, and curate documentation.

Technical Writer | Reddwerks | Austin, TX | Nov 2010–Nov 2011

- Developed company style guide with logo, corporate color scheme, font and font-size directives, and word use to ensure consistency in internal and external communication and documentation.
- Redesigned RMA forms to simplify usability and streamline the returns process.
- Provided hands-on user training to 20 warehouse workers on supply chain picking system and wearable computer software features.
- Developed training manuals and user documentation for warehouse order fulfillment system.

RELEVANT PRIOR EXPERIENCE

- Information Developer | IBM Global Services/Tivoli Software
- Information Specialist | Office of the Attorney General, Child Support Division
- Information Specialist | Comptroller of Public Accounts, Fiscal Management Division

EDUCATION

M.A. in English | Texas A&M University | College Station, TX

B.S. in English | Ball State University | Muncie, IN